

YOUR FULL REPORT

Do you show narcissistic traits?

Some self-focused defenses

Score band: 14–26 points · Personality

What this report covers

A practical look at the situations where defensiveness, comparison, or a need for special treatment may emerge.

Inside:

1. Your likely image threats
2. How to pause before self-protection takes over
3. Receiving feedback without counterattacking

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Your result

Some self-focused defenses (14–26 points)

You may lean toward status, defensiveness, or special treatment in certain situations. That is a pattern to examine, not a diagnosis.

Try this next

When criticized, ask one clarifying question before defending yourself.

Your practical guide

A practical look at the situations where defensiveness, comparison, or a need for special treatment may emerge.

1 Your likely image threats

Your self-focused defenses likely activate around specific image threats: being criticized publicly, feeling overlooked or disrespected, encountering someone more successful in your domain, or being told no by someone you consider beneath you. The tell is the emotional spike — disproportionate irritation, the urge to restore the hierarchy immediately, rehearsing a cutting response. Map your last three spikes: what was threatened was rarely the thing itself but what it meant about you. "They dismissed my idea" becomes "I am not respected." Catching that translation in real time — "my status feels threatened, not my safety" — is the master skill at this level.

2 How to pause before self-protection takes over

The pause is everything. Between the trigger and your response, insert a hard sixty seconds — physically if needed: water, bathroom, "let me think about that." During the pause, run the reframe: what is the least self-centered interpretation of what just happened? The colleague who got the praise might just have done good work; the friend who disagreed might be right. Then choose the response your non-threatened self would choose: curiosity over correction, "tell me more" over "actually." This is not suppression — it is giving your better instincts time to arrive. The first response is the defense; the second response is you.

3 Receiving feedback without counterattacking

Feedback without counterattack is a trainable skill, and it starts with the clarifying question. When criticized, your first sentence should be a question, not a defense: "Can you give me an example?" or "What would better look like?" This does three things: it buys time, it signals respect, and it often reveals the criticism is smaller than your alarm suggested. Then reflect before responding: "So you are saying I dominated the meeting — let me think about that." You do not have to agree with all feedback. You only have to prove — to them and yourself — that another person's perspective can exist in the room without being neutralized.